

The day the column ran on *The Age* and the *Sydney Morning Herald* websites my phone started to ping early with the social media swell. From academic Dr Susan Carland to former shadow treasurer John Hewson, to commentators on talkback radio, accomplished Australians weighed in on my Pocket Money Savings Plan. The reaction to the column was mixed. Some thought I was an inspiration and others thought I was a twit.

I appeared on Network Ten's *The Project* one evening and, after my interview, comedian Peter Helliar quipped, in response to the criticism of the column, 'We don't need to get angry about everything on social media.' But, of course, people did.

On Mamamia.com:

'Her name is a total oxymoron ... Empower? Not in this instance. Grow up!'

On Twitter:

'@smh @Domaincomau Emily, a house is not your most important asset. That would be your happiness.'

'Very honest and open Emily. Well done for finding a solution. #TheProjectTV'

'When strict discipline in a tough housing market means saving every penny!'

On the *Daily Mail* online:

'Good on her. It has inspired me to have a look at my finances today and take ownership. A few bad choices in your 20's like taking out two 5k credit cards when you earn very little will wind you up in a position like this. Massive regrets.'

On the *Sunrise* Facebook page:

'Most of the generation y [*sic*] have not been taught to handle money. It just burns their hands.'

'... she is full of crap ...'

On realestatetalk.com.au: